

# Conducting Qualitative Interviews with AI: Survey Instructions\*

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This file contains detailed experimental instructions for the data collections presented in the paper “Conducting Qualitative Interviews with AI”. Text in *italics* is not part of the instructions.

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## 1 Screener survey (August 2023)

The next question is about the following problem. In questionnaires like ours, sometimes there are participants who do not carefully read the questions and just quickly click through the survey. This means that there are a lot of random answers which compromise the results of research studies. To show that you read our questions carefully, please choose both “Extremely interested” and “Not at all interested” as your answer in the below question.

Given the above, how interested are you in sports?

- a) Extremely interested
- b) Very interested
- c) A little bit interested
- d) Almost not interested
- e) Not at all interested

*Only respondents who select (a) and (e) pass the attention check.*

Please explain: What is your opinion about the yearly switch to daylight saving time? Do you like or dislike it? Please use about 15-30 words.

*Only respondents who write at least 20 words are eligible to participate in an interview.*

What was your family’s gross household income in 2022 in US dollars?

[Dropdown menu]

1. How do you currently save or invest your money? Please check all that apply.

- a) I am currently unable to save money
- b) Savings or checking account
- c) Certificates of Deposit (CDs)
- d) Bonds or bond funds
- e) Money market accounts
- f) Individual stocks or stock mutual funds
- g) Real estate or property
- h) Retirement accounts (e.g. 401k, IRA)
- i) Other (please specify): \_\_\_\_\_

2. Do you currently own any individual stocks or stock mutual funds?

- a) Yes, I own individual stocks.
- b) Yes, I own stock mutual funds.
- c) Yes, I own both individual stocks and stock mutual funds.
- d) No, I do not own any individual stocks or stock mutual funds.

3. Do you plan to buy individual stocks or stock mutual funds over the next three months? (Yes / No)

4. Do you have a financial advisor who manages your investments for you? (Yes / No)

*Only if (d) was selected in Question 2:*

5. Do you own any individual stocks or stock mutual funds indirectly, such as through pension savings, retirement accounts, or other investment vehicles?

- a) Yes, I own stocks or stock mutual funds indirectly.
- b) No, I do not own any stocks or stock mutual funds indirectly.

*Only respondents who selected (a) and not (e) in Question 1; (d) in Question 2; “No” in Question 3 and 4; and (b) in Question 5 were eligible to participate in an interview on stock market non-participation.*

## **2 Main survey (August/September 2023)**

### **2.1 Pre-interview characteristics**

How often do you typically use **AI tools** such as ChatGPT, Bard or Bing per week?

- Several times a day
- About once a day
- A few times a week
- Once a week
- Less than once a week
- Never

*(New survey page)*

**Please tell us about yourself.**

What is your age?

[Dropdown menu]

What is your gender?

- Male
- Female

Which category best describes your highest level of education?

[Dropdown menu]

What is your current employment status?

[Dropdown menu]

### **2.2 Introducing the interview**

**Next up: The Interview**

You will now participate in an interview with an **AI chatbot** that will ask you questions, similar to how a human interviewer would. The topic of the interview is **stock market participation**. The AI chatbot is informed that you indicated to us in a previous survey that you do not currently own any stocks or stock mutual funds. The interview will take about **20 minutes**.

## How it works

The interview uses a chat interface, much like texting on your phone. When a question appears, you can type your response. After your response, it takes between 5 to 10 seconds for the next question to appear. Take your time in crafting your responses - there is no rush. And don't worry, there are no right or wrong answers.

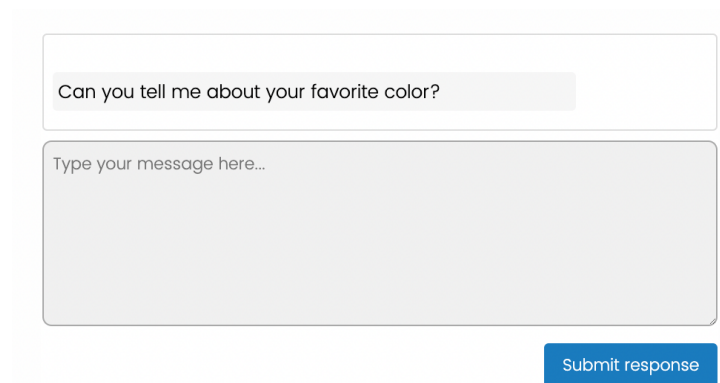
## Please note

Your responses are entirely anonymous and will be used solely for research purposes. Please do not reveal any personally identifiable information such as your name. The AI chatbot is instructed not to give financial advice or explain financial concepts. Kindly avoid such queries.

## Try it out

Below is an example of the chat interface. Please try it out before you proceed.

Figure 1: Screenshot of the training chat interface



The screenshot shows a chat interface with a light gray background. At the top, a white box contains the question "Can you tell me about your favorite color?". Below this is a large, light gray text input field with the placeholder text "Type your message here...". At the bottom right of the interface is a blue button with the text "Submit response".

*Note:* This figure provides a screenshot of the chat interface that respondents could interact with to familiarize themselves with it. Respondents were asked up to three questions about their favorite color before the "Submit response" button was deactivated. Respondents are then encouraged to proceed to the next page.

## 2.3 Interview

To ensure that the interview is as meaningful as possible, **it's important that your responses provide sufficient detail**. This means going beyond short statements, and diving into the "why" and "how". We are interested in your unique perspective and voice.

So, as we move forward, please aim to write at least **two to three full sentences** in your answers. This will provide enough depth and context for a rich and meaningful conversation. Of course, if you don't have an opinion on a topic or you're unsure, it's completely fine to express that too, with responses such as "I don't know".

*(New survey page)*

Figure 2: Interview

### The interview

Let's start the interview. Please write detailed and meaningful responses to each question to the extent that you are comfortable sharing. There are no right or wrong answers as we are interested in your unique experiences and perspectives.

It takes between **5 to 10 seconds** until the next question appears. Feel free to use this pause to reflect on the conversation.

I am interested in learning more about why you currently do not own any stocks or stock mutual funds. Can you help me understand the main factors or reasons why you are not participating in the stock market?

Type your message here...

Please write at least two or three full sentences.

Submit response

*Note:* This figure provides a screenshot of the survey page that was used to conduct the interviews for our study.

*(New survey page)*

Here is a **summary** of the previous interview.

*[Text box with a summary of the previous conversation]*

Does the above **summary accurately** represent your views expressed in the interview?

- Yes
- No

*(Only if "No" was selected in the previous question:)*

What is inaccurate in the above summary?

*[Text box for open-ended responses]*

*(New survey page)*

Thank you for completing the interview with the AI chatbot!

Before this study ends, we have some traditional survey questions relating to your financial behavior and beliefs as well as a few demographic questions that we want to ask you.

## **2.4 Multiple-choice battery**

**What are your main reasons for not participating in the stock market?** Please check all that apply.

- a) I don't know how to get started
- b) Wealth too small to invest
- c) Only few years until retirement
- d) Need cash on hand / liquidity
- e) Risk of losing a substantial part of investments
- f) Uncertainty of returns
- g) Don't trust financial professionals
- h) Stock market is too complex
- i) Setting up an investment account is too costly
- j) Managing a portfolio is too costly (time, effort, money)
- k) Don't like to think about my finances
- l) Lack of knowledge
- m) Negative experiences with the stock market
- n) Stock market returns are not high enough
- o) My labor income is too uncertain
- p) Family, friends, or coworkers advise against stocks
- q) Prefer more tangible assets
- r) Intended to invest in stocks but never got around to it
- s) None of the above

*Except for "None of the above", we randomize the order in which items are presented.*

## **2.5 Interview experience module**

How would you rate your overall experience with the interview conducted by the AI chatbot?

- a) Extremely positive
- b) Very positive
- c) Somewhat positive
- d) Neither positive nor negative
- e) Somewhat negative
- f) Very negative
- g) Extremely negative

How natural did the conversation with the AI chatbot feel?

- a) Extremely natural

- b) Very natural
- c) Somewhat natural
- d) Neutral
- e) Somewhat unnatural
- f) Very unnatural
- g) Extremely unnatural

If you were to participate in a future study involving a qualitative interview conducted through a chat interface, would you prefer texting with the same AI chatbot or an actual human interviewer?

- a) Strongly prefer AI chatbot
- b) Moderately prefer AI chatbot
- c) Slightly prefer AI chatbot
- d) No preference
- e) Slightly prefer human interviewer
- f) Moderately prefer human interviewer
- g) Strongly prefer human interviewer

Would you be interested in participating in an interview with an AI chatbot again?

- Yes
- No

## 2.6 Post-interview module

In this question we present eight different scenarios for US stock market returns over the next 12 months.

Please let us know how likely you think it is that each scenario will occur. Please type in the number to indicate the probability, in percent, that you attach to each scenario. The probabilities of the eight scenarios have to sum up to 100%.

The **US stock market return over the next 12 months** will be...

- a) More than **30%** : \_\_\_\_\_
- b) Between **20%** and **30%** : \_\_\_\_\_
- c) Between **10%** and **20%** : \_\_\_\_\_
- d) Between **0%** and **10%** : \_\_\_\_\_
- e) Between **-10%** and **0%** : \_\_\_\_\_
- f) Between **-20%** and **-10%** : \_\_\_\_\_
- g) Between **-30%** and **-20%** : \_\_\_\_\_
- h) Less than **-30%** : \_\_\_\_\_

Assume that your household's car broke down and the repair costs \$1,000. How difficult would it be for your household to take out a loan to finance this repair?

- a) Very easy
- b) Easy
- c) Neither easy nor difficult
- d) Difficult
- e) Very difficult



In case of an unexpected decline in income or increase in expenses, does your household have at least two months of income available in cash, bank accounts, or easily accessible funds?

- Yes
- No

*(New survey page)*

What is the current value of all **financial assets** (cash, savings accounts, bonds, stocks, etc.) that your household owns? Please include holdings through retirement accounts.

[Dropdown menu]

What is the current value of all **non-mortgage debt** (credit card, student debt, medical debt, auto loans, etc.) that your household owes?

[Dropdown menu]

Do you own or rent your current main residence?

- a) Own
- b) Rent
- c) Other

Do you have any mortgage debt outstanding against your household's main residence?

- Yes
- No

*(New survey page)*

*(Only shown if the respondent has outstanding mortgage debt:)*

What is the current value of all **mortgage debt** (incl. home-equity based borrowing, HELOCs, etc.) that is outstanding against your household's main residence?

[Dropdown menu]

*(Only shown for homeowners:)*

What do you think is the current value that your household's **main residence** would sell for?

[Dropdown menu]

Suppose you had \$100 in a savings account and the interest rate was 2% per year. After 5 years, how much do you think you would have in the account if you left the money to grow?

- a) More than \$102
- b) Exactly \$102
- c) Less than \$102
- d) Don't know

Imagine that the interest rate on your savings account was 1% per year and inflation was 2% per year. After 1 year, with the money in this account, would you be able to buy...

- a) More than today
- b) Exactly the same as today

- c) Less than today
- d) Don't know

Do you think the following statement is true or false? Buying a single company stock usually provides a safer return than a stock mutual fund.

- a) True
- b) False
- c) Don't know

Which of the following statements is correct? If somebody buys the stock of firm B in the stock market, then...

- a) He owns a part of firm B.
- b) He has lent money to firm B.
- c) He is liable for firm B's debts.
- d) None of the above statements are correct.
- e) Do not know.

In general, how willing or unwilling are you to take risks?

[11-point scale from "0 (completely unwilling to take risks)" to "10 (completely willing to take risks)"]

How willing are you to give up something that is beneficial for you today in order to benefit more from that in the future?

[11-point scale from "0 (completely unwilling to do so)" to "10 (completely willing to do so)"]

Generally speaking, would you say that most people can be trusted or that you need to be very careful in dealing with people?

- a) You can't be too careful
- b) Most people can be trusted

## 2.7 Sociodemographics

**Here are our final questions for you.**

Which of the following best describes your race or ethnicity?

[Dropdown menu]

Are you of Hispanic, Latino, or Spanish origin?

- a) Yes
- b) No

How many people, including yourself, currently live in your household?

[Dropdown menu]

How many children do you have?

[Dropdown menu]

What is your region of residence?

[Dropdown menu]

In which state do you currently reside?

[Dropdown menu]

*(New survey page)*

**Thank you for participating in our survey!**

If there are any remarks that you would like to make or clarifications that you would like to obtain, please do let us know by writing them into the field below.

*[Text field for open-ended responses]*

*[End of survey]*

### 3 Selection experiment (November 2023)

*We elicit the same sociodemographic variables as in the Screener Survey (August 2023). We do not replicate these instructions here.*

#### ***Introduction***

Thank you for completing the background questions in this survey. Based on your responses, you might be eligible to participate in future potential studies.

#### **Would you be interested in participating in future studies?**

On the next few pages, you will find a brief description of each study. For each study described, please indicate if you are interested in receiving an invitation to participate in that study

>>

#### ***AI interview (order randomized)***



## A 40-minute study with a qualitative interview

By Felix Chopra

 £10.00 • £15.00/hr  40 mins  80 places  Limited capacity

In this study, you will participate in a text-based interview with an AI and answer some standard survey questions about your beliefs and behavior. We expect the survey to take about 40 minutes in total.

Devices you can use to take this study:

 Desktop

If we run this study, would you like to participate in it?

☐ Yes

☐ No

>>

### ***Human interview (order randomized)***



## A 40-minute study with a qualitative interview

By Felix Chopra

 £10.00 • £15.00/hr

 40 mins

 80 places

 Limited capacity

In this study, you will participate in a text-based interview with a human and answer some standard survey questions about your beliefs and behavior. We expect the survey to take about 40 minutes in total.

Devices you can use to take this study:

☒ Desktop

If we run this study, would you like to participate in it?

☐ Yes

☐ No



### ***Survey version (order randomized)***



## A 40-minute survey

By Felix Chopra

 £10.00 • £15.00/hr

 40 mins

 80 places

 Limited capacity

In this study, you will participate in a survey and answer some standard survey questions about your beliefs and behavior. We expect the survey to take about 40 minutes in total.

Devices you can use to take this study:

☒ Desktop

If we run this study, would you like to participate in it?

☐ Yes

☐ No



#### 4 Validation survey (May 2024)

*We elicit the same sociodemographic variables as in the Screener Survey (August 2023). We do not replicate these instructions here.*

To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statement? “If you want to make any money in the stock market, you have to constantly monitor market conditions, keep up-to-date with all the news, and do a lot of research on the stocks that you plan to invest in.”

- a) Strongly disagree
- b) Disagree
- c) Somewhat natural
- d) Neither agree nor disagree
- e) Agree
- f) Strongly agree

To succeed with stock market investments, how often do you think it is necessary to monitor market conditions and check one’s portfolio?

- a) Less than once a year
- b) Once a year
- c) Once a month
- d) Once a week
- e) Multiple times a week
- f) Once a day
- g) Multiple times a day

To succeed in the stock market, how much time do you think you would typically need to spend every week to manage your investments?

- a) Less than 1 hour per week
- b) 1-3 hours per week
- c) 4-6 hours per week
- d) 7-10 hours per week
- e) 11-15 hours per week
- f) More than 15 hours per week

Which of the two statements below best describes your views?

- a) The key to stock market success is to react quickly to daily market changes.
- b) The key to stock market success is to ignore daily market changes.

Which of the two statements below best describes your views?

- a) The key to stock market success is to actively pick a few stocks that will increase in value and avoid stocks that will decrease in value.
- b) The key to stock market success is to invest broadly in all stocks without making an active selection.

Which of the following types of information do you think one would have to regularly consult when participating in the stock market to make a return on one’s portfolio? Select all that apply.

- a) Earnings reports (e.g., quarterly or annual financial statements of companies)
- b) Market reports (e.g., stock market performance summaries and trends)
- c) Forecasts from stock market analysts (e.g., buy/sell recommendations and target prices for individual stocks)
- d) Company press releases (e.g., new product launches, management changes)
- e) Technical analysis (e.g., charts and patterns predicting stock price movements)
- f) Insider trading reports (e.g., transactions by company executives)
- g) Social media and forums (e.g., investment communities, Twitter, Reddit)
- h) None of the above

## 5 Follow-up survey (May 2024)

*We include a standard attention check after the consent form and then elicit basic demographic characteristics: age, gender, education employment, income. We measure these as in our main survey. We do not replicate these instructions.*

### *Demand for insurance against nominal losses*

#### **An opportunity to get exposure to the US stock market**

We will now give you the opportunity to decide between investing \$1,000 in the US stock market for 12 months or getting \$1,000 for sure in 12 months.

#### **Loss protection**

Loss protection allows you to shield your stock market investments from losses. How much you are shielded depends on the size of the loss protection. **The higher the loss protection, the less money you have at risk.** For example:

- With 0% loss protection, all your money is at risk. You can lose \$1,000 of the initial \$1,000 investment.
- With 50% loss protection, only half your money is at risk. You can maximally lose \$500 of the initial \$1,000 investment.
- With 100% loss protection, none of your money is at risk. You cannot lose a single dollar of your initial \$1,000 investment.

If the stock market increases, you still get 100% of the upside no matter the level of your loss protection.

#### **How much loss protection do you require to put your money at risk?**

You will repeatedly choose between two options that involve payments to your Prolific account in **12 months**.

Both options are **worth \$1,000 today**. The two options differ in how their value might change over the next 12 months:

- **Option A:** Will have a guaranteed return of **0%** (and thus be worth \$1,000 in 12 months).
- **Option B:** Will provide the same return as the US stock market over the next 12 months (as measured by the S&P 500 index) with varying levels of loss protection.



## How do payments work?

**1 out of every 200 survey participants will be randomly selected.** If you are among the selected participants, we will randomly select one of the choices you make below and implement it.

- If Option A is implemented, we will transfer a \$1,000 bonus to your Prolific account in 12 months.
- If Option B is implemented, we will transfer \$1,000 adjusted for the return of the US stock market over the next 12 months and the amount of loss protection. We will also send you a monthly update about the value of your investment.

|                                      | Which option do you prefer?                 |                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>0%</b> loss protection.   |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>10%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>20%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>30%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>40%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>50%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>60%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>70%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>80%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>90%</b> loss protection.  |
| \$1,000 with a guaranteed 0% return. | <input type="radio"/> <input type="radio"/> | \$1,000 invested in the stock market with <b>100%</b> loss protection. |



## *Willingness to pay for an investment course*

### **How much do you value a stock market investment course?**

MasterClass is an online education platform known for its wide range of professionally made courses with top experts from various fields.

They've recently introduced a four-part series aimed at helping **beginners understand the basics of stock market investments** and **learn how to successfully navigate the market**. As one of the instructors puts it, "Wall Street makes things very complicated, but it doesn't have to be that way."

### **How are choices made?**

You will repeatedly choose between two options:

- **Option A:** You get free 3-month access to the "Mastering the Markets" stock market investment course from MasterClass.
- **Option B:** Varying amount of bonus payments to your Prolific account.

**1 out of every 25 survey participants will be randomly selected.** If you are among the selected participants, we will randomly select one of the choices you make below and implement it.

► Click **here** if you would like to know how you would receive access.

|                                | Which option do you prefer? |                       |                   |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$0</b> bonus  |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$2</b> bonus  |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$4</b> bonus  |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$6</b> bonus  |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$8</b> bonus  |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$10</b> bonus |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$12</b> bonus |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$14</b> bonus |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$16</b> bonus |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$18</b> bonus |
| Stock market investment course | <input type="radio"/>       | <input type="radio"/> | <b>\$20</b> bonus |



## *Belief about the performance of actively managed funds*

### **Your beliefs about the performance of actively managed funds**

A stock market fund pools money from multiple investors to invest in a diversified portfolio of stocks.

It is common to make a distinction between active funds and passive funds:

- Active funds are managed by professional fund managers who actively trade stocks and aim to outperform the market by **picking superior stocks and monitoring market conditions**.
- Passive funds try to obtain the average market return without actively picking stocks or taking market conditions into account when buying and selling.

Every year a large investment research company measures how many percent of active funds were able to outperform their passive counterpart (after fees).

**How many percent of U.S. active funds do you think outperformed their passive counterpart in 2023?** If your answer is within  $\pm 2$  percentage points of the actual answer, you will receive a **\$2 bonus**.

I think  % of active funds outperformed their passive counterpart.

Note: We will tell you the actual answer and whether you will receive the \$2 bonus at the end of the survey.



## 6 Multiple open-ended questions benchmark survey (November 2024)

*We conducted a screener survey identical to the screener survey from August 2023. Eligibility to participate in the benchmark survey was then determined based on identical criteria as in the main survey from August 2023.*

In a previous survey, you told us that you are currently not participating in the stock market. That is, you do not own any stocks or stock mutual funds. On the next pages, we will ask you six open-ended questions about your reasons for not participating in the stock market.

It's important that your responses provide sufficient detail. Please aim to write at least two to three sentences in your answers. If you don't have an opinion on a topic or you're unsure, you can express that with responses such as "I don't know".

There are no right or wrong answers; we are simply interested in your unique experiences and perspectives.

*(New survey page)*

We are interested in learning more about why you currently do not own any stocks or stock mutual funds. Can you help us understand the main factors or reasons why you are not participating in the stock market? [Text entry box]

*(New survey page)*

What barriers or challenges prevent you from participating in the stock market? [Text entry box]

*(New survey page)*

Imagine you invest in the stock market. What actions would you take, and what do you think would help you succeed? [Text entry box]

*(New survey page)*

What conditions or changes would need to happen for you to consider investing in the stock market? [Text entry box]

*(New survey page)*

As we conclude, are there any perspectives or information you feel haven't been addressed that you'd like to share? [Text entry box]

*(New survey page)*

Reflecting on our conversation, what would you identify as the main reason you're not participating in the stock market? [Text entry box]